



DCS Replay Deck

Rewind a DCS track. Mark the good bits. Find every missile launch.

Version 1.1.0 • Support and updates: <https://discord.gg/PGfmpJMeY5>

DCS lets you fast-forward a replay but has never let you go back. Miss a shot and your only option is reloading the track and sitting through it again.

Replay Deck fixes that, and adds the things you need around it: named marks you can jump between, proper slow motion, and a timeline showing every missile launch, hit and kill that DCS recorded.

Install

- 1 **Download** `ReplayDeck.exe`
- 2 **Run it.** It installs its own DCS hook the first time. Nothing to unzip, nothing to copy.
- 3 **Restart DCS.** DCS only loads hooks when it starts, so this step is unavoidable.

Windows will warn you the first time

The download is not code-signed, so Windows SmartScreen shows “**Windows protected your PC**”. Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**.

That warning means “this publisher has not paid for a certificate”, not “this file is dangerous”. If you would rather verify it yourself, the SHA256 of the official v1.1.0 download is:

AA1542AAB4B139C9EE586BFF92034C50074F9A3C66F379A1DBB9085D79DB3E04

Check it in PowerShell with `Get-FileHash ReplayDeck.exe` and only run it if it matches.

Nothing is written into your DCS install

The hook goes into `Saved Games\DCS\Scripts\Hooks\`, so it survives DCS updates and cannot break an integrity check. To remove Replay Deck completely, delete `ReplayDeck.lua` from that folder and bin the exe.

Getting started

- Start a replay in DCS from the **Replay** menu, as you normally would.
- Run **Replay Deck**. The lamp top-left turns green and reads **replay connected**.
- If it says **waiting for DCS**, see Troubleshooting on the last page.

Jumping back

The **–10s / –30s / –60s / –5m** buttons jump back from wherever the replay is now. Use these when something happened and you did not mark it.

Marks

A mark is a moment you want to come back to, possibly many times.

Button	What it does
◆ MARK HERE	Pauses the replay immediately and lets you type a name. The pause is deliberate: missiles come in quick succession, and you should not lose the next one to typing. Press Enter or continue when you are done and it resumes at normal speed.
← last mark	Jumps back to the most recent mark before where you are.
next mark →	Runs forward to the next mark. No restart needed, so this is much quicker.
go / X	In the mark list: jump to that mark, or delete it.

Every jump to a mark lands **10 seconds before** it, paused, in F2 view at normal speed. You press play and record. Marks are saved per mission, so they are still there next time you open that track.

Events

Replay Deck reads DCS's own debriefing data and puts every shot, hit and kill on the timeline. No Tacview needed, and it works on tracks you flew months ago.

Click **events: N** to open the list on the right. Click any row, or any red triangle on the timeline, to jump to it.

Events appear after a replay pass finishes

DCS only writes its debriefing data when a mission ends, so a track shows no events until you have run it through once (or seeked to the end). After that they are saved and appear instantly every time you open that track.

Reading the timeline

Marker	Meaning
▼ red triangle	Something DCS reported: a launch, a hit, a kill. Click to jump there.
amber line	One of your marks.
blue line	Where a jump-back landed. Click it to clear it.

Why a rewind takes a moment

DCS cannot actually rewind, and never could. A track file is the mission, plus a recording of every command you pressed, plus a random seed. DCS re-runs the whole thing from the beginning every time you play it. There is no saved snapshot of minute 47 to jump back to.

So Replay Deck rewinds the only way anything can: it restarts the track and fast-forwards back to the moment you asked for, then pauses on the exact second. One button instead of a menu crawl, and you can go and make a cup of tea while it works.

While it runs it switches to the F10 map, then puts you back in F2 at normal speed when it arrives. The status line tells you how much track is left and roughly how long.

How long, roughly

Track	Fast-forward rate	One hour of track
Short single-player	around 24x	about 2.5 minutes
Busy multiplayer	around 6.6x	about 9 minutes

Measured on the development machine. Yours will differ — it depends on your CPU and how much the mission has going on. Short tracks are near enough instant.

The seek button

seek: steady / fast / max sets how hard it pushes DCS's time acceleration. Higher is quicker, but DCS becomes unstable at extreme acceleration on unit-heavy missions and can crash — a DCS limitation, not this tool, and why the default is not max.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to do
waiting for DCS , lamp stays grey	The hook is not loaded. Close DCS <i>completely</i> , then start it again — DCS only loads hooks at startup. Make sure you have started an actual replay, not just reached the main menu.
More than one DCS install	The button top right of the deck shows which DCS folder is in use. Click it to switch, or browse if your Saved Games lives somewhere unusual.
Speed buttons do nothing	If you run DCS as administrator, run Replay Deck as administrator too. Windows blocks keystrokes from a normal program to an elevated one.
events: none yet	Run the track through to the end once. DCS only writes its debriefing data when a mission finishes.
A rewind seems stuck	Check the status line. If the time remaining is counting down it is working, just slow — long multiplayer tracks take a few minutes. If it is frozen, press cancel and try again.

Something broken, or an idea? Come and say hello in Discord — bugs, feature requests and “it did something weird” are all welcome.

<https://discord.gg/PGfmpJMeY5>

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